

IT CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT
MODULE 4 REVIEWER
TOPIC: SALES PROCESS AUTOMATION

I. SALES PROCESS AUTOMATION (SPA)

Sales Process Automation (SPA) = using technology, mainly CRM systems, to streamline, standardize, and automate repetitive tasks in the sales cycle.

Main purpose:

- Make sales processes faster and more consistent.
- Reduce repetitive manual work.
- Help sales representatives focus on high-value activities.
- Improve customer experience through quick and personalized responses.

WHY IS SPA IMPORTANT?

For Sales:

- SPA becomes a daily toolkit for managing sales activities.

For Marketing:

- Helps understand how leads move into the sales process.

For Management:

- Provides visibility.
- Helps with accurate forecasting.
- Helps optimize the sales process.

II. SALES PIPELINE

Sales Pipeline = a visual representation of where potential deals are in the sales process.

It shows the structured journey of a lead from initial contact until becoming a customer.

WHY MAP THE SALES PIPELINE?

- 1. Clarity**
 - Gives everyone a clear and shared understanding of the sales process.
- 2. Consistency**
 - Ensures sales representatives follow a standardized process.
- 3. Visibility**
 - Allows managers to see the health and status of sales efforts.
- 4. Forecasting**
 - Helps predict future revenue more accurately.
- 5. Optimization**
 - Helps identify bottlenecks and areas that need improvement.

III. TYPICAL SALES PIPELINE STAGES

1. PROSPECTING / LEAD GENERATION

Meaning:

- Identifying potential customers who may be interested in a product or service.

Activities:

- Research
- Cold calls
- Cold emails
- Content downloads
- Event attendance

Goal:

- Generate initial interest and contact.

Transition:

- Lead becomes a Qualified Lead or Opportunity.

2. QUALIFICATION

Meaning:

- Determining whether a lead is a good fit and has potential to become a customer.

Activities:

- Discovery calls
- Needs analysis
- Asking questions

BANT criteria:

- Budget
- Authority
- Need
- Timeline

Goal:

- Determine if the lead is worth pursuing.

Transition:

- Qualified Lead becomes a Prospect or Opportunity.

3. NEEDS ANALYSIS / DISCOVERY

Meaning:

- Understanding the prospect's challenges, pain points, and goals.

Activities:

- Detailed conversations
- Solution mapping
- Understanding current processes

Goal:

- Discover specific problems that the product can solve.

Transition:

- Clear understanding of the prospect's needs.

4. SOLUTION PRESENTATION / DEMONSTRATION

Meaning:

- Showing how the product or service addresses the prospect's needs.

Activities:

- Product demonstrations
- Customized presentations
- Case studies

Goal:

- Show the value and benefits of the solution.

Transition:

- Prospect understands the solution's value.

5. PROPOSAL / QUOTE

Meaning:

- Giving the prospect a formal offer.

Usually includes:

- Proposed solution
- Pricing
- Terms
- Conditions

Activities:

- Drafting proposals
- Sending quotes
- Clarifying details

Goal:

- Give the prospect a clear path to purchase.

Transition:

- Prospect reviews the offer.

6. NEGOTIATION / OBJECTION HANDLING

Meaning:

- Addressing concerns, objections, or requests for changes.

Activities:

- Price negotiations
- Contract reviews
- Competitor comparisons
- Addressing customer concerns

Goal:

- Overcome obstacles and move toward closing the deal.

Transition:

- Agreement is reached on terms.

7. CLOSED-WON / CLOSED-LOST

Meaning:

- The final outcome of the sales process.

Closed-Won:

- The deal is successfully completed.
- The customer is secured.
- May proceed to onboarding.

Closed-Lost:

- The deal is not completed.
- Analyze why the deal was lost.

Goal:

- Secure the customer OR learn from the loss.

EASY TO REMEMBER:

Prospecting → Qualification → Discovery → Demo → Proposal → Negotiation → Closed

P → Q → D → D → P → N → C

IV. CUSTOMIZING THE SALES PIPELINE

Important points:

- Every business has a unique sales process.
- The number and names of stages may vary.

- Each stage should represent a distinct step.
- Each stage should have clear entry and exit criteria.
- CRM systems allow businesses to customize pipeline stages according to their sales methodology.

V. AUTOMATING SALES TASKS

Sales task automation = using technology to automatically perform repetitive and time-consuming sales activities.

Main benefit:

- Sales representatives have more time for engaging with prospects and closing deals.

KEY SALES TASKS THAT CAN BE AUTOMATED

1. EMAIL SEQUENCES

Automation:

- Automatically sends a series of personalized emails based on triggers.

Examples of triggers:

- After a demo
- After form submission
- When there is no response

Benefits:

- Consistent follow-up
- Saves time
- Keeps leads warm

Example:

- A 3-email sequence is automatically sent over one week to prospects who downloaded a product brochure.

2. TASK CREATION & REMINDERS

Automation:

- Automatically creates follow-up tasks based on deal stage changes or specific actions.

Examples:

- Call prospect in 2 days.
- Send proposal.
- Schedule a demo.

Benefits:

- Prevents leads from being forgotten.
- Improves organization.
- Increases productivity.

Example:

- When a deal moves to "Proposal Sent," the CRM automatically creates a task to follow up in 3 days.

3. DATA ENTRY & UPDATES

Automation:

- Automatically logs emails, calls, and meetings.
- Updates customer or deal records using integrations.

Benefits:

- Reduces manual data entry.
- Reduces errors.
- Keeps CRM information updated.
- Saves time.

Example:

- An email sent from Outlook is automatically logged in the CRM contact record.

4. LEAD ROUTING & ASSIGNMENT

Automation:

- Automatically assigns new leads to the correct sales representative.

Assignment can be based on:

- Geography
- Industry
- Company size
- Round-robin

Benefits:

- Faster follow-up
- Prevents missed leads
- Balances workload

5. MEETING SCHEDULING

Automation:

- Allows prospects to book meetings directly on a sales representative's calendar.

Benefit:

- Eliminates back-and-forth emails.
- Makes scheduling faster.
- Improves the prospect experience.

6. QUOTE GENERATION & CONTRACT MANAGEMENT

Automation:

- Generates quotes and proposals using CRM data.
- Integrates with e-signature tools for contract signing.

Benefits:

- Reduces errors.
- Speeds up the sales cycle.
- Improves professionalism.

VI. TOOLS FOR SALES AUTOMATION

1. CRM Systems

Examples:

- HubSpot Sales Hub
- Salesforce Sales Cloud

Purpose:

- Provide extensive sales automation capabilities.
- ### **2. Marketing Automation Platforms**
- Can integrate with CRM systems.
 - Can automate lead nurturing.
- ### **3. Third-Party Integrations**
- Examples:
- Scheduling tools
 - E-signature tools
 - Data enrichment tools

MAIN IDEA:

Automation → More Efficiency → More Consistency → More Effective Sales

VII. DEAL MANAGEMENT

Deal Management = systematically tracking and moving opportunities through the sales pipeline.

CRM provides a centralized place for managing active deals.

IMPORTANT DEAL INFORMATION IN A CRM:

- Deal Name
- Associated Contact(s)
- Associated Company
- Deal Stage
- Amount
- Close Date
- Probability
- Activities
- Notes
- Next Steps

BENEFITS OF DEAL MANAGEMENT

1. Visibility
 - Managers can see every deal and its status.
2. Standardization
 - Ensures sales representatives follow the same process.

3. Collaboration
 - Allows sales teams to work together on complex deals.

VIII. SALES FORECASTING

Sales Forecasting = predicting future sales revenue using current deals in the sales pipeline and historical data.

PURPOSE:

- Predict future revenue.
- Support business planning.
- Help managers make better decisions.

IX. CRM FORECASTING CONCEPTS

1. PIPELINE VALUE

Pipeline Value = sum of all deals currently in the sales pipeline.

Example:

- Deal 1 = ₱100,000
- Deal 2 = ₱200,000
- Deal 3 = ₱300,000

Pipeline Value = ₱600,000

2. WEIGHTED PIPELINE

Weighted Pipeline = Deal Amount × Probability

It gives a more realistic estimate of expected revenue.

Example:

- Deal Amount = ₱100,000
- Probability = 50%

Weighted value:

₱100,000 × 50% = ₱50,000

3. DEAL VELOCITY

Deal Velocity = how long deals typically stay in each stage or the total time from deal creation to closing.

Purpose:

- Understand how quickly deals move through the pipeline.

4. CONVERSION RATES

Conversion Rate = percentage of deals that move from one stage to another.

Examples:

- Qualified Lead → Opportunity
- Opportunity → Closed-Won

Purpose:

- Measure how effectively leads move through the sales process.

X. SALES FORECASTING METHODS

1. OPPORTUNITY STAGE FORECASTING

- Forecast based on the current stage of each deal.

2. HISTORICAL DATA FORECASTING

- Uses previous sales trends to predict future performance.

3. LEAD-BASED FORECASTING

- Predicts sales based on the number and quality of new leads.

4. AI-POWERED FORECASTING

- Uses AI/ML to analyze:
 - Historical data
 - Customer behavior
 - Other external factors

Purpose:

- Provide more accurate predictions.

XI. BENEFITS OF DEAL MANAGEMENT & FORECASTING

1. Improved Planning
 - Helps businesses plan resources, production, and marketing.
2. Resource Allocation
 - Helps managers determine where sales representatives need support.
3. Performance Management
 - Provides a basis for evaluating sales team performance.
4. Early Warning System
 - Identifies possible revenue shortfalls early.
5. Investor Confidence
 - Accurate forecasts help attract and retain investors.

XII. IMPORTANT DIFFERENCES

SALES PIPELINE

- Shows where deals are in the sales process.

DEAL MANAGEMENT

- Tracks and manages individual opportunities.

SALES FORECASTING

- Predicts future sales revenue.

SALES PROCESS AUTOMATION

- Uses technology to automate repetitive sales activities.